

Cell Phones

A cellphone is a basic necessity these days, and about as essential to daily urban life as food and water. Choosing one however, is easier said than done, which is where we come in...

Business phones

Nokia E63

Nokia's E63 offers 90 per cent of what the E71 does, minus GPS, a really well-laid out keypad and a metal body. But the price is too good to be true, yet it is — Rs. 11,500 is a superb buy and it wins a Zero 1 Award.



Best Performers

Nokia N96 & Blackberry Curve 8900

The best of the multimedia and business worlds respectively, the Nokia N96 and Blackberry Curve 8900 are two very different beasts but in general, they both excel at what they do. Very good all-round phones, great signal and call quality, build quality and keypads. The N96 is a very capable multimedia device while the Curve 8900 really cuts it for the corporate audience. We haven't tested anything better this year.



Ultra High-end multimedia phones

Nokia N97 & Samsung Omnia HD

The N95 8 GB is an excellent phone, but it's also a model that has been around for well over two years, making it Jurassic in the fast moving world of the smart-phone. Its screen, battery life, call quality and feature-set were exemplary for its day, but it faces the heat from the duo of newcomers. The Samsung Omnia HD is a very good phone with the odd quirk.

Shockingly the N97 also fell sharply in price, making it comparable to the Omnia HD. Both of these phones offer more features than the now-ageing N95 8 GB, and the Omnia HD actually has a superb capacitive touch screen, making it better for touch use than the N97. However, the N97 has better call and signal quality and a QWERTY keypad. In the end, we're calling it a tie — both the Nokia N97 and the Samsung Omnia HD impressed us equally, they both win a Digit Zero1 Award.



Entry-level smartphones

LG KM 335

A basic smartphone and one that is available for a lot less than when we tested it, thanks to it being referred to as an "older" model. However, available for around Rs. 5,000, it's a lot of phone for the price and makes a sensible buy for those looking at something other than Nokias and Sony Ericssons.

